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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

White House freezes adult education funds

City’s programs in limbo as administration withholds grant dollars

By **Kate Armanini**
Chicago Tribune

Joe Walsh spiraled deep into a depression after he lost his two siblings. It landed him at a men’s shelter at Rogers Park.

“My life fell apart, and everything was a mess, and I was trying to hold the family together,” said Walsh, a former mariner from Peoria. “I had to make a decision to save my own life.”

Now, the 36-year-old sat at a desk in a sunlit classroom. Beside him were seven other men, most of whom were also unhoused or in recovery. For two weeks at A Safe Haven Foundation in North Lawn-

dale, they’d worked on resumes, job applications and interviews. Several planned to transition into the foundation’s vocational training programs.

For the first time in months, Walsh allowed himself a bit of hope. He plans to take a welding course next, and has started reconnecting with family members.

“Now I’m more independent, just kind of rebuilding my life,”

Walsh, 36, said. “I’m able to talk to my kids again.”

But those classes — and other adult education programs nationwide — are in limbo after the Trump administration abruptly froze nearly \$7 billion in already-approved federal education grants last week. State agencies were notified the night before funds were set to be disbursed July 1, with little explanation from the

Education Department.

It’s the latest in President Donald Trump’s sweeping offensive to cut back the federal government’s role in education, leaving schools and nonprofits scrambling to stretch funding.

“It’s created havoc in the whole system,” said Mark Mulroe, president of A Safe Haven. “It’s just

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Jacob Henry watches monitors in the control room at the Clinton single-reactor nuclear power station on June 23. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Tech giants positioned to reshape energy policy

A nuclear plant deal in Clinton sets the stage for AI billionaires like Mark Zuckerberg to change the future of Illinois’ power supply

By **John Lippert**
Chicago Tribune

As Facebook founder Mark Zuckerberg expands his ravenous data centers, he’s agreed to take over subsidies that Illinois ratepayers have been providing to a nuclear power station in central Illinois since 2017. The move could be the first step in a Silicon Valley bailout of nuclear power stations that supply half the electricity generated in Illinois.

Last month, Zuckerberg announced a 20-year stipend for a Constellation Energy nuclear

plant in Clinton, a rural community 25 miles south of Bloomington. He’s helping to plan a second and perhaps even a third reactor for the site and may help foot the bill.

Constellation views its agreement with Zuckerberg as a potential template for four other Illinois nuclear plants where ratepayer subsidies are also set to expire in 2027, said Mason Emmett, Constellation’s senior vice president for public policy.

The biggest nuclear provider in the United States, Constellation owns all six Illinois nuclear plants

and has close ties with other artificial intelligence giants. This includes Microsoft, with which Constellation agreed last year to restart a nuclear reactor at the Three Mile Island plant in Pennsylvania.

By pouring money into nuclear, Zuckerberg and his fellow artificial intelligence billionaires are marking the start of a new epoch in Illinois energy policy.

They stand at the forefront in deciding which power plants Illinois will keep open, expand or

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Trump: 25% tax for Japan, SKorea

Nations warned over retaliatory tariffs in social media post

By **Josh Boak**
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump on Monday set a 25% tax on goods imported from Japan and South Korea, as well as new tariff rates on a dozen other nations that would go into effect on Aug. 1.

Trump provided notice by posting letters on Truth Social that were addressed to the leaders of the various countries. The letters warned them to not retaliate by increasing their own import taxes, or else the Trump administration would further increase tariffs.

“If for any reason you decide to raise your Tariffs, then, whatever the number you choose to raise them by, will be added onto the 25% that we charge,” Trump wrote in the letters to Japanese Prime Minister Shigeru Ishiba and South Korean President Lee Jae-myung.

The letters were not the final word from Trump on tariffs, so much as another episode in a global economic drama in which he has placed himself at the center. His moves have raised fears that economic growth would slow to a trickle, if not make the U.S. and other nations more vulnerable to a recession. But Trump is confident that tariffs are necessary to bring back domestic manufacturing and fund the tax cuts he signed into law Friday.

He mixed his sense of aggression with a willingness to still negotiate, signaling the likelihood that the drama and uncertainty would continue and that few things are ever final with Trump.

Imports from Myanmar and Laos would be taxed at 40%,

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ELECTION 2026 9TH CONGRESSIONAL DISTRICT

Race heats up as two legislators join large Democratic field

By **Olivia Olander**
Chicago Tribune

The race to replace longtime U.S. Rep. Jan Schakowsky is getting more crowded.

State Sen. Mike Simmons will launch his campaign Tuesday, he told the Tribune, joining recently announced state Rep. Hoan Huynh — who also planned a campaign kickoff event Tuesday evening — and some 10 other Democratic candidates vying for the seat.

The latest campaign announcements come just ahead of the Cook County Democratic Party’s planned slating meetings next week, when the party is

expected to endorse candidates ahead of the 2026 primary.

As with many races in Democratic-leaning districts, the campaign in the 9th Congressional District, which covers a swath of Chicago’s North Side and suburbs from Evanston west to Algonquin, is shaping up around concerns over economy and the disruption brought on by policies under President Donald Trump’s administration.

“I’m running because the communities in the 9th District have raised me, and they’re struggling,” Simmons said Monday. “It’s one of the most

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BRANDON BELL/GETTY

Texas flood toll

A person sifts through children’s belongings at Camp Mystic on Monday in Hunt, Texas. The death toll from catastrophic flooding along the Guadalupe River over the July Fourth weekend has surpassed 100 as the massive search continues for missing people. **Story in Nation & World**

